

Figurative Language - Workbook 1

Focused practice - Workbook 1 of 3

How to use this workbook

Read each short text closely. Answer without checking the key. Then compare your reasoning with the explanation and mark the mistake type if you were wrong.

Before you start

- Underline or mentally mark the exact wording that controls your answer.
- Do not choose an option just because it is true in general; it must fit this text.
- After checking, write one sentence explaining why the strongest wrong answer fails.

Morning Platform

When the delayed train finally appeared, the platform exhaled. People lowered their phones, lifted their bags, and moved toward the doors.

1. What does the platform exhaled mean?

- A. The concrete platform breathed.
- B. The waiting crowd released tension and began moving.
- C. A train released smoke.
- D. The platform became empty immediately.

2. What effect does the phrase create?

- A. It makes the crowd's relief feel collective.
- B. It explains train engineering.
- C. It proves the station is outdoors.
- D. It makes the delay longer.

Email Queue

By lunch, new requests were pouring into the support inbox.

3. What does pouring into suggest?

- A. Requests were arriving rapidly and continuously.
- B. Liquid entered the computer.
- C. The inbox stopped working.
- D. Only one request arrived.

4. Why is the phrase more effective than were in?

- A. It emphasizes movement and volume.
- B. It changes the time of day.
- C. It proves the requests were urgent.
- D. It names a technical process.

Community Hall

After the argument, silence sat between the two committee members.

5. What does the phrase mean?

- A. A person named Silence sat down.
- B. The tension between them remained strongly noticeable.
- C. Both members left the room.
- D. The meeting ended peacefully.

6. What does this image emphasize?

- A. the emotional distance between the speakers
- B. the size of the room
- C. the number of chairs
- D. the meeting schedule

Answer key and reasoning

Morning Platform

1. B. The personification transfers the idea of releasing a breath to the crowd's shared relief.
2. A. Treating the platform as one body compresses the crowd's shared reaction into a vivid image.

Email Queue

3. A. Pouring creates an image of a steady, strong flow.
4. A. The figurative verb makes the rate and quantity easier to imagine.

Community Hall

5. B. The personification makes the silence feel like a physical presence separating them.
6. A. The physical image of something sitting between them represents tension and distance.

Mistake review

- If you chose a familiar meaning that did not fit the context, label it wrong sense.
- If you chose an option based on one word but ignored the rest of the passage, label it one-clue trap.
- If you understood the basic meaning but missed attitude or effect, label it effect missed.
- Redo the question later without looking at the key.